[METRIC]
H-B-371F
February 16, 1995
Superseding
H-B-371E
May 18, 1977

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, ARTIST'S, MARKING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this federal specification for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers artist's marking brushes of one type and grade.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes. Brushes covered by this specification shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2):

3 mm. (7/64 in.)
4 mm. (11/64 in.)
6 mm. (15/64 in.)

The size is the inside diameter of the ferrule at the brush end.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-1880 - Brushes; Preparation for Delivery of

(Copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available from the following address: GSA Specifications Section (3FBP-W), Suite 8100, 470 L'enfant Plaza SW, Washington, DC 20407.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any other data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, GSA Center (10FTE), Auburn, WA 98001

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT: Approved for public release; Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8020

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD 105 – Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other Publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials:

ASTM D13 – Specification for Spirits of Turpentine

(Application for copies of ASTM Standards should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3 REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials and Components. Materials and components shall conform to the requirements specified herein.

3.1.1 Bristle. The bristle shall be natural hog bristle, unbleached and undyed and shall be either natural black or varied colors used separately or blended together. The bristle shall be thoroughly boiled or steamed and straightened. Bristles shall be properly prepared so as not to twist or curl and shall be free from reconditioned bristle and adulterants. When tested as in 4.4.1.2(c), no more that 5 bristles shall be pulled loose. A certificate of compliance from the supplier that the bristle meets all requirements (stiffness, sterilization and straightness) may be accepted. The contractor shall provide certification that color(s) has not been added to the bristles.

3.1.2 Ferrule. The ferrule shall be made of a corrosion resistant metal or metal that is made corrosion resistant by electro-plating.

3.1.3 Handle. The handle shall be of close grained hardwood, finished or unfinished, or shall be of a synthetic material with all sprues and runners removed. Coated handles shall not wrinkle, blister, or become soft or dull when tested as described in 4.4.1

3.1.4 Setting compound. The setting compound shall be a compound which shall withstand the tests specified in 4.4.1. without softening or deteriorating and without loosening of bristle in the setting compound.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Ferrule. The ferrule shall be round, one piece, seamless, and shall be secured to the handle by crimping. The ferrule shall not have any ragged edges.

3.2.2 Handle. The handle shall be of the regular long-handle style.

3.3 Physical requirements. The brushes shall conform to the physical requirements in Table I.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-04-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Physical Requirements

	Size		
	2.8 mm. (7/64 in.)	4.4 mm. (11/64 in.)	6 mm. (15/64 in.)
Handle length, min. cm.(in.)	21.6 (8-1/2)	23.5 (9-1/4)	23.5 (9-1/4)
Ferrule:			
Depth, min. mm.(in.)	25 (1)	29 (1-1/8)	32 (1-1/4)
Diameter at bristle, min. mm.(in.)	2.4 (3/32)	4.0 (5/32)	5.6 (7/32)
Thickness of metal, min. mm. (in.)	.25 (.010)	.25 (.010)	.25 (.010)
Bristle:			
Hold in ferrule, min. mm.(in.)	12.7 (1/2)	12.7 (1/2)	12.7 (1/2)
Length outside ferrule, min. mm.(in.)	19.1 (3/4)	25.4 (1)	31.8 (1-1/4)
Weight of bristle per brush, min. gm. (oz.)	0.31 (0.011)	0.59 (0.021)	0.87 (0.031)

3.4 Marking for identification. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) and in addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, each brush shall be stamped or otherwise permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark and the National Stock Number (NSN).

3.5 Workmanship. The finished brushes shall be clean, well made, securely assembled, and free from any defects which may affect appearance or serviceability. There shall be no sharp edges, splinters, burrs, or other imperfections. The brushing part shall be trimmed evenly and uniformly with the flagged ends preserved to the finished length outside the ferrule.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order , the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein using facilities acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any inspection herein when deemed necessary to assure that the brushes conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with 3.3 and section 5 of this specification. The examination shall be conducted as specified in PPP-B-1880.

4.3 Inspection and testing of end item

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional inspection. The sample unit for this inspection shall be one completed brush. Samples shall be selected using inspection level II for brushes subject to visual inspection, and inspection level S-2 for brushes subject to destructive test inspection. Sample brushes shall be subjected to visual inspection in accordance with table II. For major defects, the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective, and for minor defects the AQL shall be 6.5 percent defective.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II Classification of defects

Defects	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Bristle:		
Material not as specified	X	
Ferrule:		
Material not as specified	X	
Depth not as specified		X
Edges ragged		X
Not properly crimped to handle	X	
Handle:		
Not smoothly finished with varnish, lacquer, or other organic finish		X
Identification marking:		
Not properly marked		X
Workmanship:		
Defects which affect appearance		X
Defects which affect serviceability	X	

4.4 Testing procedures. Samples selected in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass any test shall be cause for rejection of the lot. All tests shall be evaluated for conformance to the requirements in section 3.

4.4.1 Solvent Testing

4.4.1.1 Handle (Organic coating) Brush handles with organic coating shall be tested as follows:

A. With the brushing end up, approximately one-half of the handle shall be immersed for 30 minutes in a commercially available mineral spirits. After 30 minutes the handle shall be removed and examined. There shall be no wrinkling, blistering, or separation of the coating.

B. With the brushing end up, approximately one-half of the handle shall be immersed for 30 minutes in turpentine conforming to ASTM D13. After 30 minutes the handle shall be removed from the turpentine and examined. There shall be no wrinkling, blistering, or separation of the coating.

C. The brush handle shall be dried for two hours and the organic coating shall be examined. The coating shall not be wrinkled, blistered, or separated from the handle and the coating shall not be soft.

4.4.1.2 Base material, filler strips, synthetic handles. The brush shall be tested for solvent resistance using a commercially available lacquer thinner. (NOTE: The organic coating on the handle may be removed by this solvent. The objective is to test solvent resistance of the handle base material, filler strips, and the setting compound.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The brush shall be suspended so that the brushing part and approximately one-half of the ferrule are immersed in lacquer thinner for one hour. Synthetic handles shall be immersed to a depth of one-half of the handle length. The brush shall be removed and examined as follow:

A. Handle and ferrule. As soon as the brush is removed form the lacquer thinner, the brush shall be dried for two hours and examined for softening or dulling of the handle coating or deterioration of the handle base material.
B. Filler strips (if applicable). Filler strips shall be examined for softening, swelling, or other deleterious change.

C. Setting compound. After drying, the setting compound shall be examined for softening, blistering, cracking, or other deleterious effects of the solvent. The brush shall be suspended by the handle in a holding device and a group of bristles/hair 6 mm. (1/4 in.) in diameter shall be given a tensile pull test at random places one time for each 2.5 cm. (1 in.) of brush width. After thorough drying the brush shall be examined for solvent damage to the handle base material (synthetic handles). The ferrule shall be removed and the setting compound shall be examined for deterioration, loosening of the bristles/hair, or other solvent damage.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-B-1880. The level of packaging and packing shall be A or commercial, and the marking shall be civil, military, or as specified (see 6.2).

6. Notes

6.1 Intended use. Paint brushes covered by this specification are primarily intended for marking shipping boxes, crates, barrels, and similar articles. They may also be used for school easel work and for household and industrial touchup work.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in the procurement of documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2.1)
(c) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records, when applicable (see 4.1
(d) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).
(e) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.1).

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

CIVIL AGENCIES COORDINATING:

GSA - FSS
VA
DCG
FPI
POS
COM-NBS
CPS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.